

Ballast — video production plan

A filmed pitch: a presenter on camera, short drama beats from real student life, keyword graphics, and long demos of the features that carry the idea.

Target 4:30

Hard limit 5:00

13 scenes

~600 spoken words

4 locations · 1 shoot day

The rubric — and exactly what full marks says

Presentation is **15%** of the total. Green is the band this plan is built to land in.

CRITERION	%	0–1	2–3	FULL MARKS
Clarity of explanation	5%	Confusing; idea not understandable.	Understandable but patchy.	4–5 · The idea is explained clearly and is easy to grasp.
Structure and flow	4%	Disorganised, hard to follow.	Some structure but jumps around.	4 · Logical, well-paced flow from problem to solution.
Delivery and confidence	4%	Hesitant or flat, hard to engage with.	Reasonably confident, some energy.	4 · Confident, engaging, and convincing.
Engagement and persuasiveness	2%	0 · Doesn't make the idea feel worth building.	1 · Somewhat compelling.	2 · Makes the idea feel genuinely valuable and exciting.

The host's hint, quoted

"Your **Ideation (25%)** is judged solely from your **README.md**, not your video, which means you do not have to spend time in your video discussing all the ideas you had and why they were dropped. Spend the 5 minutes you have to explain **your idea** to the viewer, **why it is novel**, **how it will be built**, and **why it deserves to be built**. You will lose marks for Presentation (15%) if your video exceeds the 5 minute limit (as stated in the rubrics)."

What that buys us. Zero seconds on dropped ideas, alternatives, or process — that is a full minute back, and it goes straight into demo. Every scene below is tagged with which of the host's four jobs it does: **IDEA · NOVEL · BUILT · WHY**. Eight of the thirteen scenes are the product actually working.

Where the time goes

Feature weighting is deliberate: the four that carry the daily loop get real demo time, the timetable and the friend planner get the longest demos, and the five-area screen is a single sentence.

FEATURE	SCREEN TIME	WHY THAT MUCH
 Timetable HERO DEMO	26s	The set-up moment, and the flags are the most original single idea in the app. Shown in full.
 Friends — plan something HERO DEMO	24s	The only feature that solves a problem between people. Shown end to end, right through to the two shared evenings.
 Owing FEATURE	26s	Including "book my sittings for me", which is the hardest thing in the app to build and the easiest to explain.

★ Priority list FEATURE	22s	Answers the question a student actually asks. Both halves — what first, and what you may move.
🌙 Tonight FEATURE	22s	Including the badminton slider, which is the moment it stops feeling generic.
🌿 Recovery FEATURE	20s	Rest as a debt, and booking it into a gap that exists.
📅 Plan · Rebalance · Saying no	24s	Compressed into one scene — the wall, the locked deadline, the drafter.
📱 Five dials at capture	18s	Kept, because it is the novelty.
📺 The five-area screen	~4s	One sentence, inside the scene above. Deliberately brief.

DRAMA	PRESENTER	IDEA	DIALS	TIMETABLE	OWING	PRIORITY	WALL+NO	RECOVERY	TONIGHT	FRIENDS	BUILT	CLOSE
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Amber is a feature demo. Longest single block is 26 seconds — that rhythm is what stops four and a half minutes feeling like eight.

Cast, locations, kit

Cast — three people is enough

- **PRESENTER.** Your most confident speaker. On camera in scenes 2, 12, 13; in voice-over throughout. **Same outfit all day.**
- **STUDENT A.** The drama lead. **No dialogue at all** — cast whoever is most relaxed on camera, not the best talker.
- **FRIENDS B & C.** Two extras, about eight seconds of screen time.

Locations — four, all on campus

- **DESK / BEDROOM, night.** Scenes 1, 8b, 13 end.
- **LIBRARY, day.** Scene 8a.
- **OUTDOOR or plain wall, day.** Scenes 2, 12, 13 — every presenter piece.
- **CORRIDOR / café.** Scene 11 drama.

Kit. A phone on a tripod is fine in 1080p. What matters: **the microphone** — record narration separately, indoors, into earbuds or a cheap lav, never an on-camera mic outdoors. And **daylight on the face**: stand facing a window, or with the sun behind the camera.

The shooting script

Every scene states **who** is in it, **where** it is shot, **what** happens and **how** to frame it. **Red** is the beat that must land on the cut.

TIME	WHAT / HOW / WHO / WHERE	SAY	ON SCREEN
0:00 12s DRAMA IDEA	WHAT — Sunday, 1:47am. STUDENT A at a messy desk, blank document, phone buzzing. They open a to-do app: "3 tasks today." They close it and stare at nothing. HOW — Three shots, ~4s each. Clock · blank doc over-shoulder · wide of stillness. Handheld is fine. WHO — STUDENT A, no dialogue. WHERE — Desk, lights low.	<i>First five seconds: no narration. Room tone only.</i> "It's Sunday night. Your planner says three tasks. It doesn't say one of them is a presentation you've dreaded all week."	SUNDAY · 01:47 3 tasks today
0:12 20s PRESENTER IDEA	WHAT — First piece to camera. Name the flaw, name the product. HOW — Mid-shot, chest up, off-centre with space on the lens side. Eyes on the lens. Two-second insert of laundry and a lecture theatre on "an hour of laundry". WHO — PRESENTER. WHERE — Outdoor / plain wall, daylight.	"I'm [NAME]. And that's the flaw in every planner ever made — they count hours. " An hour of laundry is not an hour of a group presentation. So two weeks look identical, and one of them quietly breaks someone. This is Ballast ."	EVERY PLANNER COUNTS HOURS BALLAST title card
0:32 18s DEMO NOVEL	WHAT — The core claim. /welcome . HOW — Drag the dread dots on the presentation up to 4 while speaking. Let the bars visibly swap before the next line. Hold 2s. WHO — Voice-over. WHERE — Screen capture.	"One idea. Load equals time times dread. " Three hours you're dreading. Six hours you enjoy. Drag the dots — and the three-hour task overtakes the six-hour one.	load = time x dread large, held 4s

Half the hours. Twice the load."

0:50

18s

DEMO

NOVEL

WHAT — The dials, then the battery. **Keep the five-area screen to one sentence** — it is the least surprising part of the app.

HOW — /add → Assignment → Next → Next. **Drag Mental, then Time, then Social — slowly.** Then a 4-second cut to Home.

WHO — Voice-over. **WHERE** — Screen capture.

"So when you add something you drag **five faces** — head, hours, body, social, admin — and it lands in all of them.

Which gives you one number. Forty-seven percent, and *which part of you* is empty."

ONE TASK · FIVE AREAS

47% LEFT

1:08

26s

DEMO

HERO

NOVEL

WHAT — Timetable, in full. The set-up moment.

HOW — /timetable/import : **paste a block of text in and let the preview list appear.** Cut to /timetable : **tap "Gives exam tips", then "Attendance counted" — let each chip turn red.** Then **press "View these in my week"** and land on Plan with the flagged lecture on the rail.

WHO — Voice-over. **WHERE** — Screen capture.

"Now, set-up. **Paste your timetable** straight from your portal — any format. Anything it can't read, it hands back rather than dropping.

Then **flag the lectures that matter more.** This one gives exam tips. That one sets coursework. This one's attendance is counted — and it warns you *before* you drop under eighty percent.

Flag a lecture, and nothing in this app will ever move it."

PASTE · DON'T RETYPE

💡 GIVES EXAM TIPS

🔒 NOTHING MAY MOVE IT

1:34

26s

DEMO

HERO

NOVEL

WHAT — Owing, and the planner.

HOW — Home scrolled to the **Owing** band. **Point at the three-state bar as you name the three states.** Then **press "Book 3 sittings for me"** and hold on the result, including the line about hours it cannot fit. This is your single strongest demo — do not rush it.

WHO — Voice-over. **WHERE** — Screen capture.

"An assignment due Thursday is nine hours spread across the days *before* Thursday. So it sits on **every single day** until it's done — hours finished, hours booked, hours still loose.

And **this books your sittings for you.** It reads your real week and spreads them across your lightest days, two hours at a time. It even tells you the hours it **can't** fit."

DONE · BOOKED · LOOSE

IT PLANS YOUR SITTINGS

2:00

22s

DEMO

FEATURE

NOVEL

WHAT — The priority list, both halves.

HOW — /priority . **Scroll slowly so two or three reason chips are readable** — "Due today", "Hard deadline", "Not enough time left". Then scroll on to **Could move** and hold.

WHO — Voice-over. **WHERE** — Screen capture.

"Twelve things and no idea where to start? **One ranked list.** How close the deadline is, who you promised, how much is left — and whether it can even still be finished.

And then the half nobody asks: of all this, **what are you actually allowed to move?** "

WHAT TO DO FIRST

...AND WHAT YOU MAY DROP

2:22

24s

DRAMA

DEMO

NOVEL

WHAT — The pile-up, the trade sheet, the drafter. Three fast beats.

HOW — a) STUDENT A adds a third sticky note to a wall planner; all three land in one week; they step back.

Third note lands on the word "seventy-two". b) /rebalance — **toggle two trades, then tap the locked Group presentation and let it refuse.** c) STUDENT A types and deletes a message twice, then hard cut to /decline/w11-

"It also watches for the pile-up. Three deadlines inside **seventy-two hours** is a wall — and it warns you **eight days out.**

Then it prices what you could put down. The group presentation? **Locked.** An app that suggests skipping your exam is one you stop trusting.

WARNED 8 DAYS EARLY

🔒 LOCKED

IT NEVER SENDS ANYTHING

	birthday . WHO — STUDENT A + screen. WHERE — Library, then desk, then capture.	And the message you've been avoiding for four days? It writes it."	
2:46 20s DEMO FEATURE NOVEL	WHAT — Recovery as a debt. HOW — /recover : hold on -11h and the owed-versus-banked bar. Cut to /prescription : pick a duration, then a time from the real gaps, and watch the battery preview climb. WHO — Voice-over. WHERE — Screen capture.	"Rest isn't an absence here. It's a credit you're owed — in hours, carried forward. She's eleven hours down, and has been for nine days. So it matches something to the area that still has room, and books it into a gap that actually exists. Protected time."	-11 HOURS OWED REST IS A DEBT, NOT AN ABSENCE
3:06 22s DEMO FEATURE NOVEL	WHAT — Tonight, and the badminton slider. HOW — /actions → tap "A recovery night" and let the percentage jump → /tonight/what → scroll to the Badminton slider and drag it. Land on the "1 of your own above" line. WHO — Voice-over. WHERE — Screen capture.	"Tonight is the part of the day you haven't lived yet. Pick a kind of night, and see what it costs before you choose. And add what you <i>actually</i> do. Amira plays badminton — so badminton is a slider. The five we ship are a guess about somebody else's life."	TRY IT BEFORE YOU LIVE IT YOUR HOBBIES, NOT OURS
3:28 24s DRAMA DEMO HERO NOVEL	WHAT — Friends, end to end. HOW — a) 6s split screen: A types "you free this week?" and deletes it; B does the same. b) /areas/social — hold on the four batteries (62 · 24 · 8 · 71), then tap "A walk", then a friend, and let the shared windows recompute. Hold on Wed 12 Nov, 6–8pm. WHO — A and B, then screen. WHERE — Corridor, then capture.	"Nobody sees their friends in week ten because everyone assumes everyone else is busier. So pick who, and what — dinner, a walk, a day trip — and it intersects their free evenings with the real gaps in yours, and offers only the ones that work for everybody. Their battery sits next to their name. A band, never a number."	"you free this week?" struck through 2 EVENINGS THAT WORK FOR EVERYONE A BAND, NEVER A NUMBER
3:52 20s PRESENTER BUILT	WHAT — Feasibility. Presenter beside a laptop, turns the screen to the lens. HOW — Start on the presenter, cut to three inserts: the live URL typed · the architecture diagram from README §5.2 · a 4x sped-up recording of npm run preflight finishing green. WHO — PRESENTER. WHERE — Laptop / desk, daylight.	"Expo and React Native — iOS, Android and web. Live right now, no install, no sign-in. Everything runs on the phone: no server, no network. And none of this is a mock-up — three hundred and thirteen automated checks prove every button does what it claims."	iOS · ANDROID · WEB WORKS OFFLINE 313 AUTOMATED CHECKS
4:12 18s PRESENTER WHY	WHAT — The close. HOW — Step half a metre closer than scene 2 so the frame is tighter; it reads as conviction. Slow down. On the last line, cut to STUDENT A from the cold open closing the laptop and turning the lamp off. WHO — PRESENTER, then STUDENT A. WHERE — Wall, then desk.	"Three weeks after finals adds accounts and sync — the only thing it can't already do on its own. Every wellbeing app tells a drowning student to <i>breathe</i>. Ballast tells them which three things to put down — and writes the awkward message for them. Ballast. The weight you carry on purpose."	3 WEEKS TO SYNC End card, 3s in silence: BALLAST load-balancer-ballast.expo.app

Shot list, grouped by location

Shoot in this order, not script order — it is one day instead of three.

BLOCK	SCENES	WHO	SHOTS TO GET
A · Outdoor / wall daylight, ~30 min	2, 12, 13	Presenter	All three presenter pieces back to back, two takes minimum each . Scene 13 framed tighter than scene 2. Grab 10s of the presenter silent and smiling as a cutaway safety net.
B · Desk, night lamp only, ~30 min	1, 8c, 13 end	Student A	Clock close-up · blank doc over-shoulder · wide of stillness · two type-and-delete takes · laptop closing and lamp off.
C · Library ~15 min	8a	Student A	Hands adding sticky notes to a wall planner · wide of A stepping back and going still.
D · Corridor / café ~10 min	11a	A and B	Two matching over-shoulder shots of typing and deleting the same message.
E · Screen capture no cast, ~40 min	3–11	—	<code>/welcome</code> · <code>dread drag</code> · <code>/add to page three</code> · <code>Home</code> · <code>/timetable/import paste</code> · <code>/timetable</code> · <code>flag taps</code> · <code>"View these in my week"</code> · <code>Owing "Book 3 sittings"</code> · <code>/priority</code> · <code>both halves</code> · <code>/rebalance</code> · <code>toggles + the locked row</code> · <code>/decline/w11-birthday</code> · <code>/recover</code> · <code>/prescription</code> · <code>booking</code> · <code>/actions</code> · <code>preset</code> · <code>/tonight/what</code> · <code>badminton</code> · <code>/areas/social</code> · <code>planner</code> . Plus a terminal run of <code>npm run preflight</code> .
F · Narration indoors, quiet, ~20 min	all	Presenter	Record the entire script in one sitting, including the on-camera lines — it gives the editor a clean fallback anywhere the sync sound is poor.

Before any of it: open the app → **Areas** → **Reset to the seeded week**, and confirm Home reads **47%**. Every number spoken in this script comes from that state.

Keyword graphics

Nineteen text cards. One font, one weight, one position per type. Motion is a fade or a 6-frame slide — nothing spinning.

Full-screen — 3–4s on a colour panel

load = time × dread

BALLAST

ONE TASK · FIVE AREAS

313 AUTOMATED CHECKS

Lower third — over footage, 2s

EVERY PLANNER COUNTS HOURS

PASTE · DON'T RETYPE

WARNED 8 DAYS EARLY

REST IS A DEBT, NOT AN ABSENCE

IT NEVER SENDS ANYTHING

A BAND, NEVER A NUMBER

TRY IT BEFORE YOU LIVE IT

Pinned to the UI — tracks the screen

47% LEFT

💡 GIVES EXAM TIPS

🔒 NOTHING MAY MOVE IT

DONE · BOOKED · LOOSE

IT PLANS YOUR SITTINGS

WHAT TO DO FIRST

–11 HOURS OWED

🔑 YOUR HOBBIES, NOT OURS

2 EVENINGS THAT WORK

Plus full subtitles throughout. Assume part of the panel watches muted.

Edit and performance

Assembly order

Performance — this is the 4% for Delivery

1. Lay the **full narration** end to end and trim to 4:20. That is your spine.
2. Drop the three presenter pieces onto their lines, synced by waveform.
3. Fill with demo capture. Speed screen recordings to **1.2x** — UI always plays slower than it feels.
4. Cut the drama in last, to the beat.
5. One instrumental bed, low. Lift it at 1:08 for the feature run; drop it out completely under the final line.

- **Smile on the first line of scene 2.** It is audible, and it buys you the opening.
- **Eyes on the lens**, never on your own preview. The single biggest tell of a nervous pitch.
- **Slow on numbers:** "forty-seven percent", "eight days out", "three hundred and thirteen".
- **Land the jokes and move on.** No pause for a laugh that isn't in the room.
- **Scene 13 is slower and quieter** than everything before it. Conviction, not volume.
- Fluffed a line? Re-say it cleanly and keep rolling — fixing it in the edit costs eight seconds.

If the cut lands over 4:50 — trim in this order

1. **Scene 9, Recovery (-6s)** — drop the prescription half, keep the ledger and "a credit you're owed".
2. **Scene 1, cold open (-4s)** — open on the blank document instead of the clock.
3. **Scene 8, the sticky-note drama (-5s)** — go straight to the collision card on screen.
4. **Scene 11a (-4s)** — one typing shot instead of the split screen.

Never cut: the dread drag (0:32) · the timetable flags (1:08) · "book my sittings for me" (1:34) · the friend planner (3:28) · "313 automated checks" (3:52). Those five carry Clarity, Novelty and Feasibility between them.

Five ways teams lose Presentation marks

1. **Running over.** The host says it plainly: over five minutes *loses marks*. Export, watch, check the runtime.
2. **Explaining the ideation.** Marked from the README. Here it is a minute you cannot afford.
3. **Narrating the UI.** "Now I click here..." — say what it *means*; let the screen show the click.
4. **Slides with no product.** You have a live app, and two thirds of this is it working. That is the advantage.
5. **Trailing off.** End on the line and the held card. No "...so, yeah, thanks for watching."